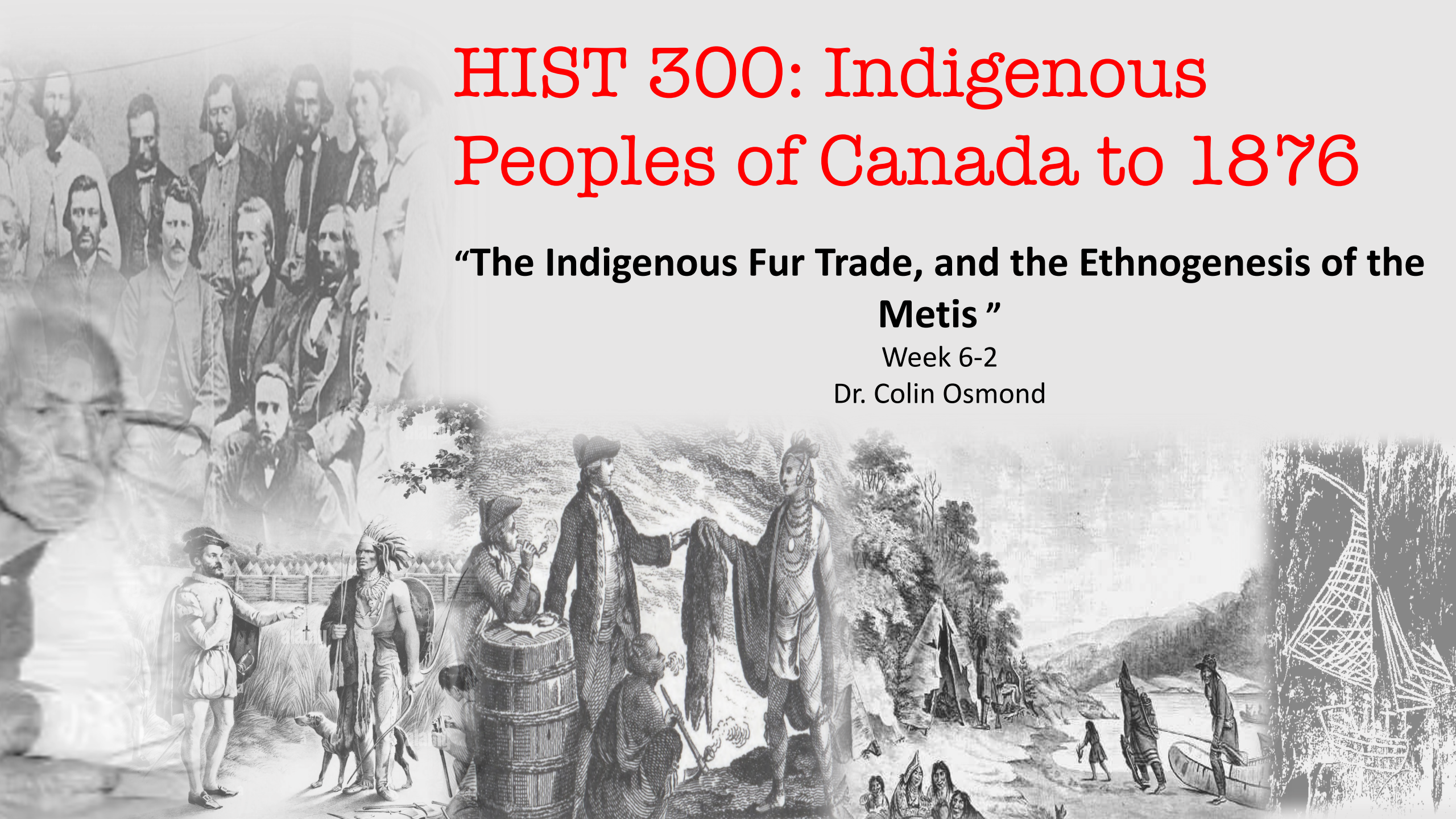
HIST 300: Indigenous Peoples of Canada to 1876

“The Indigenous Fur Trade, and the Ethnogenesis of the Metis ”

Week 6-2

Dr. Colin Osmond



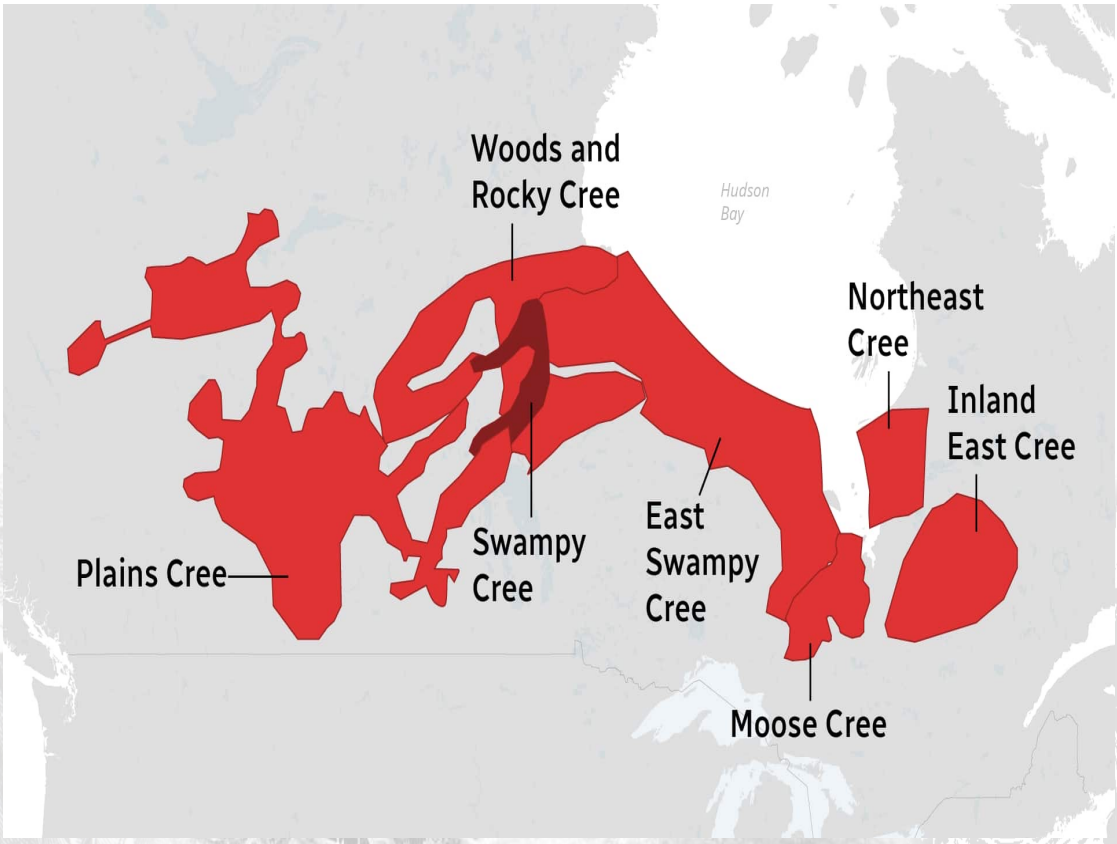
Recap:

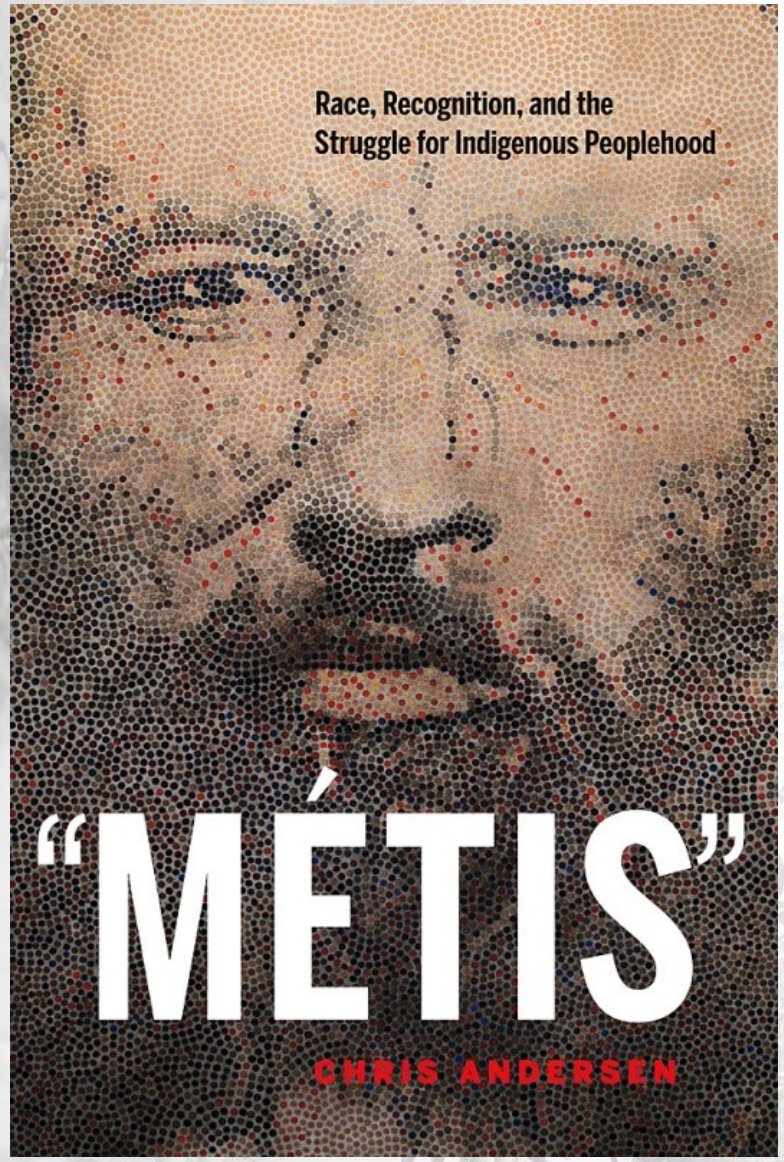
- Myth of the “Ecological Indian”
- Pleistocene Extinctions
- Reintroduction of horses to the Plains
- Introduction of Guns
- Rise of Horse Empires
- A new market for an Indigenous Commodity - Pemmican

Learning Outcomes/Keywords

- The Indigenous Fur Trade
- Ethnogenesis (emergence) of the Metis as a distinct cultural Nation
- Born out of the fur trade
- Result of marriages between Indigenous women and fur traders (kinship)
- Marriage a la facon du pays (of the custom of the country) for the French
- Country Marriages for the British


INDIGENOUS PEOPLES OF
THE NORTH AMERICAN PLAINS
SARCEE
PLAINS
CREE
PLAINS
OJIBWA
(SAULTEAUX)
BLACKFOOT
CANADA
UNITED STATES
ASSINIBOIN
ATSINA
HIDATSA
MANDAN
CROW
TETON
SANTEE
ARIKARA
Mississippi
CHEYENNE
YANKTON
PONCA
Missouri
OMAHA
IOWA
PAWNEE


Woods and
Rocky Cree
Hudson
Bay
Northeast
Cree
Inland
East Cree
Plains Cree
Swampy
Cree
East
Swampy
Cree
Moose Cree

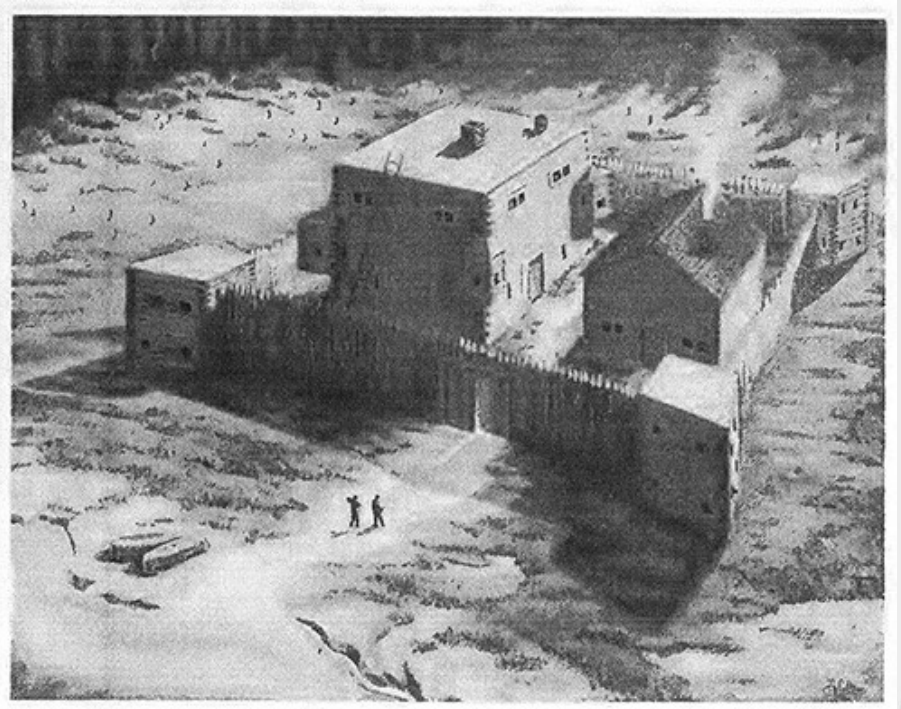


Métis vs. métis?

Hudson's Bay Company

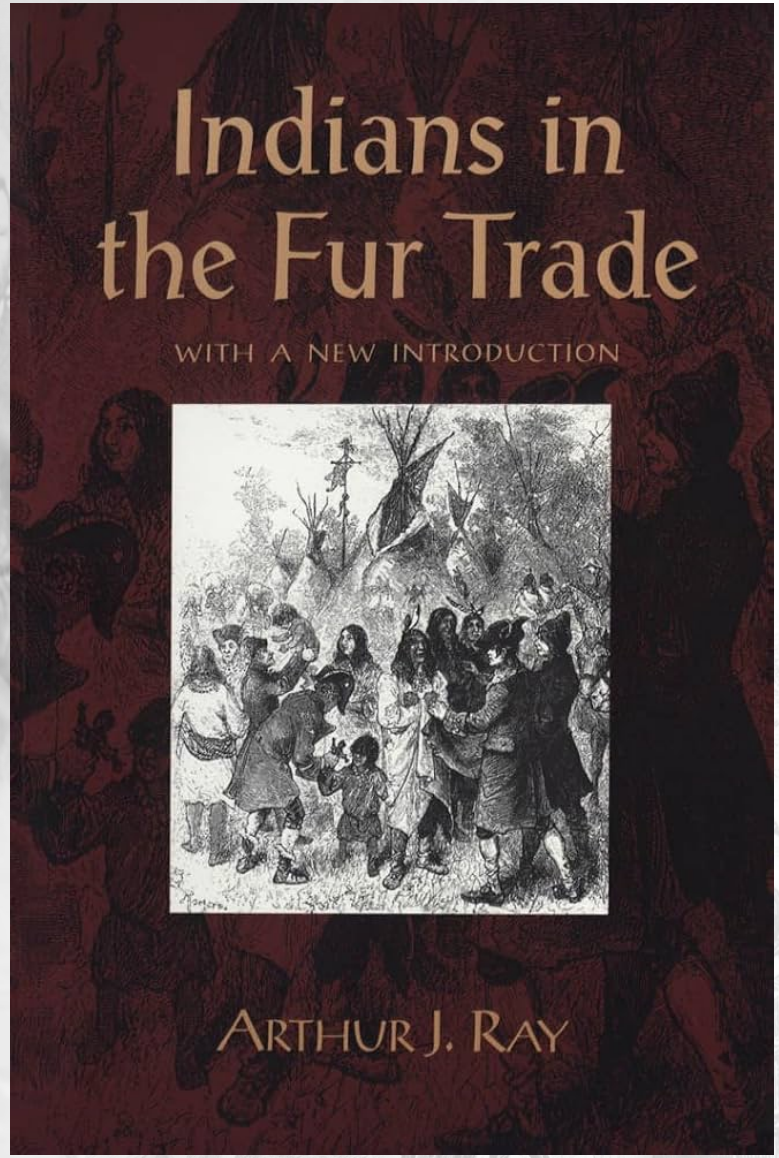
Formed 1670, given massive monopoly over "Rupert's Land"







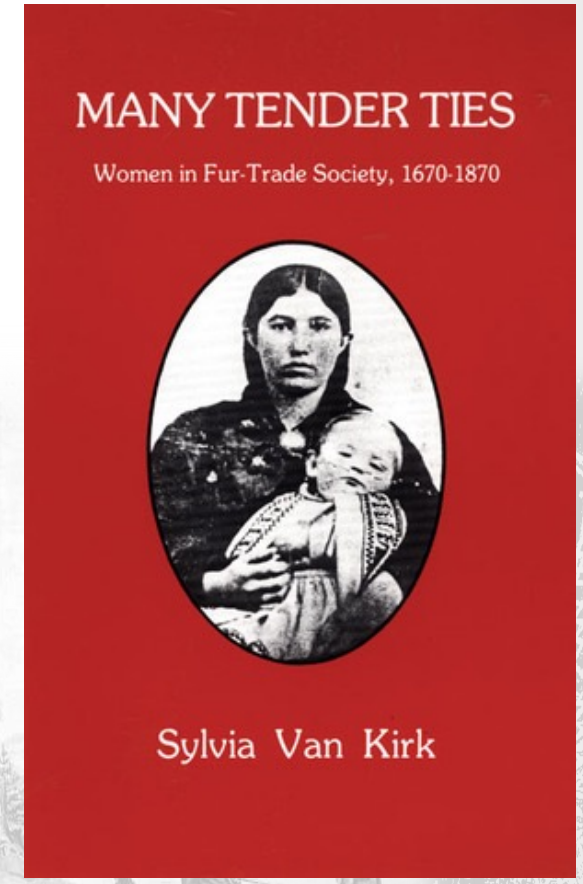

Fur Trade Routes, 1755
Ft. Churchill
York Factory
Ft. Albany
Quebec
Trois-Rivieres
Montreal
Ft. Frontenac
Ft. Michilimackinac
Albany
Ft. Rouille
Ft. Niagara
Ft. de la Baye
Ft. Detroit
Ft. St. Joseph
Ft. Miami
Ft. Ouiatanon
Ft. St. Joseph
St. Joseph River
Wabash River
Kaskaskia River
French Outposts
British Outposts
Trade Flows
British
French



Indians in the Fur Trade?

“Le mariage à la façon du pays”
“Marriage in the custom of the Country”
”Country Marriages”





Fur Trade Society

- Some Métis children lived at fur trade posts (even after being abandoned by European fathers)
- They became the next generation of the fur trade company (HBC, NWC, etc.)
- Other Métis children (especially as part of French/Cree kinship systems) lived along fur trade routes in the west
- The latter group formed the nucleus of the Métis Nation as a distinct political Nation
- Fur Trade unions created a new class of people – either mixed ancestry or Métis – that were intertwined in the Fur/Pemmican trade



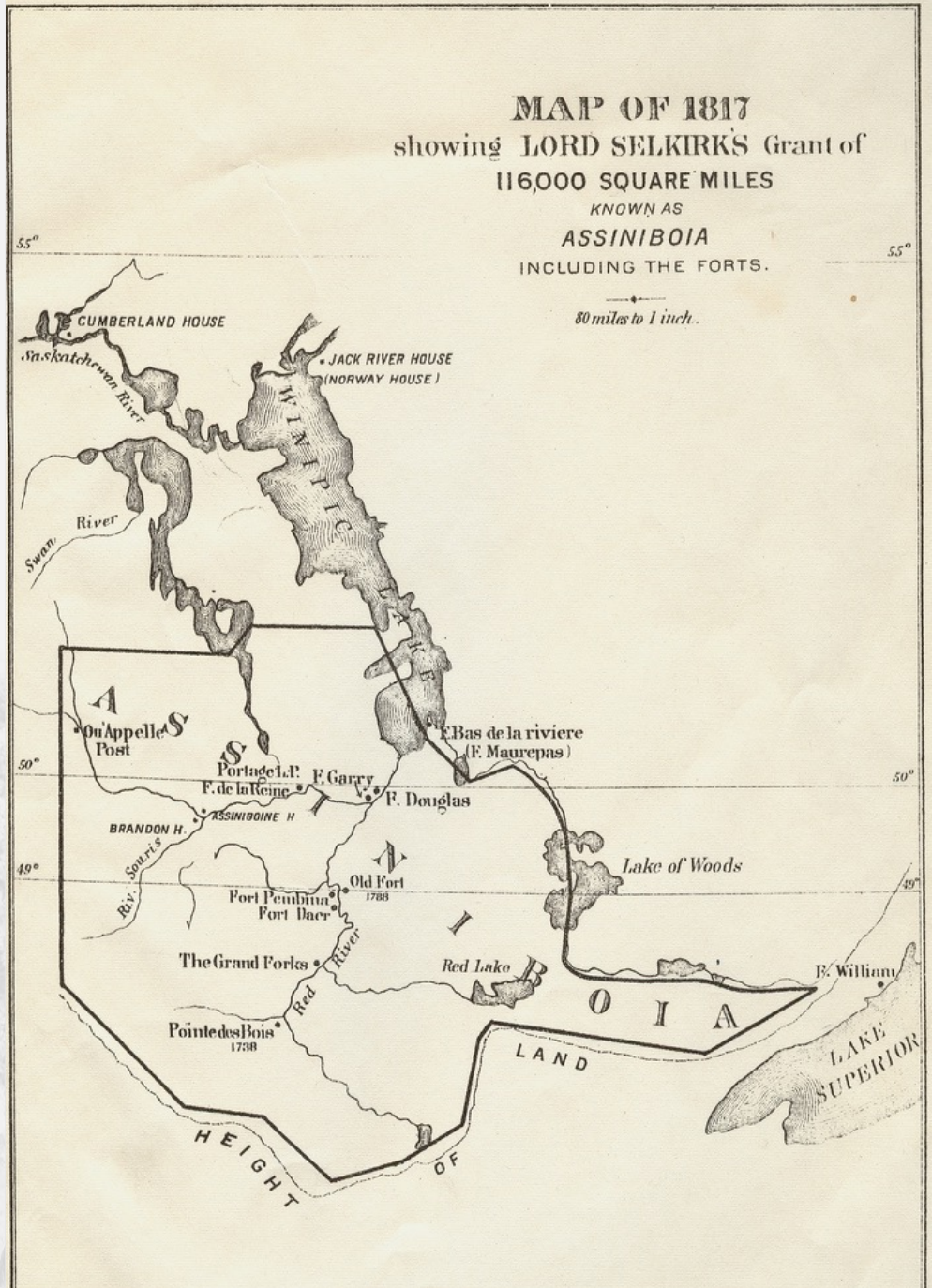


Métis and the Fur Trade

- As fur trade expanded to the west – the Métis became central partners in the fur/pemmican supply chain
- Worked in all aspects – trade post chief traders, voyageurs, trading partners, wintering partners, fur trappers, pemmican producers.
- Over time, metis communities formed their own unique political/social identity – Métis Nation
- Centered at Red River – where the prairies (pemmican trade) and the woodlands (fur trade) met.

Pemmican Proclamation

- Northwest Company (NWC) was the Métis's main purchaser of Pemmican at Red River
- HBC wanted to do two things:
  - Interrupt the NWC's supply of Pemmican at Red River
  - Tap into the Métis Market for Pemmican at Red River
  - (Remember- the HBC had claimed all of this land as their trading territory – the Northwest/Rupert's Land)
- 1811- Selkirk Colony approved by HBC – new European (mostly Scottish) settlers arrived in Red River region (taking lands claimed by the Métis)
- HBC declared the Pemmican Proclamation in 1814
  - Made the export of pemmican illegal, under guise that it would take away food from Selkirk settlers
  - Métis see this as a direct attack on their economy, and to their rights over the land




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Pemmican Wars

- Pemmican was the fuel for the fur trade
- HBC and NWC would pay big prices for it
- Indigenous traders could play one company off the other
- This advantage ended with merger of HBC/NWC in 1821
- Prices cut in half by HBC – now Indigenous people had to make twice as much product to maintain their economy
- By 1860s – Bison stocks are almost totally gone

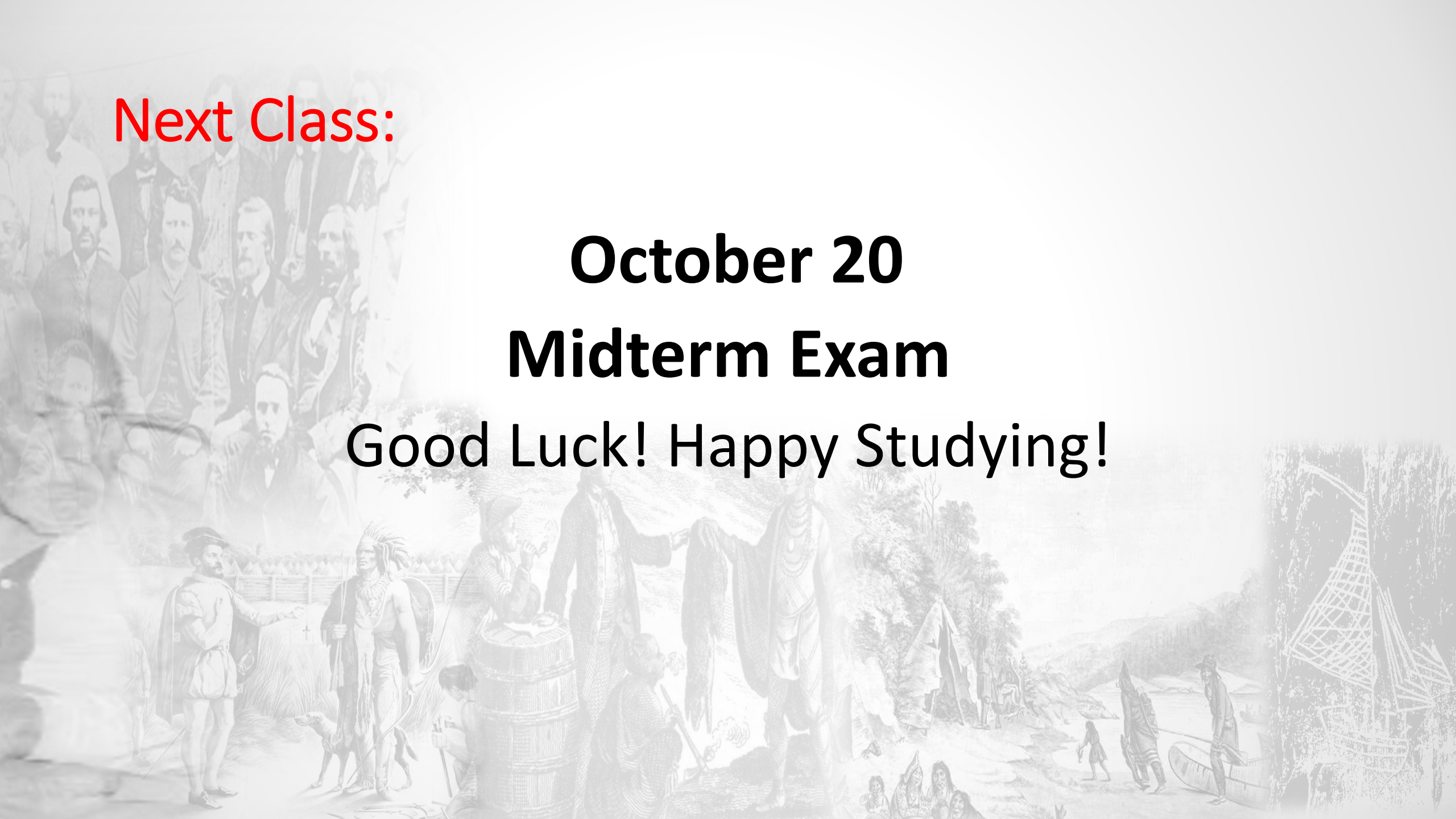




Bison rawhide harvesting camp near Dodge City, Kansas, 1876



Pile of Bison Skulls and Bones near Saskatoon, late 1880s



Next Class:

October 20

Midterm Exam

Good Luck! Happy Studying!

Primary and Secondary Sources

- **Primary Sources:** First-hand account of an event or time. Recorded by a person/people at the time an event occurred, or during the time period in question.
- **Examples:** Letters, diaries, oral history, journals, newspapers, photographs, film, paintings, survey data, pamphlets, census reports, etc.
- **Secondary Sources:** Interpretations and arguments made about the past using primary sources. They often cover the same material and topics as primary sources, but also contain the author's interpretations and inferences.
- Secondary sources mobilize primary sources to make assumptions about the past.
- **Examples:** Books, Articles, Documentaries, Academic Journals, etc.
- Remember: Secondary sources can become primary sources. For example, if you're studying the way historians writing in the 1870s understood the history of the 17th century, a secondary source textbook from the 1870s will give you insights about how historians understood 17th century history in the 1870s. This can be helpful if you are studying how knowledge has changed over time.

Evaluating Primary Sources

- Who Wrote this Document? What role or position did this person play (e.g., government official, concerned citizen)?
- Do you know for whom it was written? Or, what its intended audience was?
- Do you know, or can you guess, why the author wrote it? What might be the goal or purpose? What was the context?
- What does the source claim?
- What can you infer (conclude) from the document?

Evaluating Secondary Sources

- Many of the same things you would ask about a Primary Source-
  - Who Wrote this Document? What role or position did this person play (e.g., government official, concerned citizen)?
  - Do you know for whom it was written? Or, what its intended audience was?
  - What does the source claim?
- What evidence does the author use? Can it be validated?

Is it a good secondary source?

- Where was it published?
- What are the authors credentials?
- Does it back up claims with evidence?
- Is the information open source (i.e. Wikipedia)?
- When was it written? Has our knowledge of the topic changed? Has new information been found?
- Does it leave anything out?

Recording Important Information from Sources

- Reading Cards
  - *Author(s) Name*
  - *Title*
  - *Publishing Date*
  - *Citation info*
  - *Chronology/Geography Covered*
  - *Main Argument(s)*
  - *Conclusion(s)*
  - *Evidence Used (Oral history, diaries, letters, newspapers, etc.)*
  - *Strength of argument/limitations*
  - *How does it relate to other readings for this course/topic?*